A-A-51300A
4 June 1990
SUPERSEDING
A-A-51300
14 March 1986

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

MICROTOME, Rotary, Automatic

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description in preference to Military Specification MIL-M-36314B which is cancelled.

This Commercial Item Description covers one type of automatic-feed rotary microtome suitable for serial sectioning of specimens.

Salient Characteristics:

Shall be a bench mounted hand wheel operated, automatic specimen feed, rotary type microtome designed for serial sectioning of paraffin embedded tissues.

Shall as a minimum consist of a base, handwheel, object clamp, course advance handwheel, knife holder and cover. The micrometer system should be maintenance free. The horizontal feed system shall be independent of the vertical movement of the specimen and shall consist of an enclosed micrometer spindle feed assembly. The thickness adjustment shall be from 1 to 50 microns. The housing shall be protected with a front cover to prevent paraffin debris from entering the mechanism.

Shall be supplied with the following configurations:

A jaw clamp/knife holder
A quick release cassette clamp/disposable blade holder

Shall include a micron thickness indicator on the front of the housing to indicate the selected thickness of the specimen being sectioned. A dial or knob controlled thickness indicating scale shall be permanently marked with the following specimen thickness increments for the indicated thickness ranges:

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At least 1 micron increments for a 1 to 10 micron sectioning thickness.
At least 3 micron increments for a 10 to 20 micron sectioning thickness.
At least 5 micron increments for a 20 to 50 micron sectioning thickness.

Shall provide a knife holder base that will accommodate either a knife holder or disposable blade holder. It shall allow for movement toward and away from the specimen, laterally as well as angle adjustments. The knife holder base shall bear an angle adjustment scale from 0 to 10 degrees in 5 degree minimum increments.

Shall allow specimen holders to be easily interchanged from a jaw clamp to hold large paraffin blocks or embedding rings, to a universal quick release cassette clamp. The object clamps shall have the ability to easily undergo X/Y orientation to adjust the block cutting surface to the knife edge. The universal knife holder base shall easily accommodate either a knife holder or a disposable blade holder.

Shall be supplied with the following accessories:

Two each: 120 millimeter (mm) size microtome knives with a detachable handle (NOTE: One knife may be furnished without the handle).

Three object disks with necessary inserts or supports, one each with the following diameter: 7/8 inch or 25 millimeter, 1-1/8 inches, and 1-1/2 inches.

One disposable knife blade holder that is fabricated of corrosion-resisting steel, and is capable of securely locking an extra heavy or wafer thin disposable knife.

A minimum of thirty (30) microtome type extra heavy steel single edge razor blades.

A protective cover.

Two (2) Allen wrenches (if required).

One screwdriver (if required).

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Shall be provided with two copies each of one or more service data booklets containing complete instructions for installation, operation, maintenance, and a list of component parts. Each part of the microtome, other than common fasteners shall be identified in the service data and parts list by the manufacturer's part number.

Workmanship. The automatic rotary microtome shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

Unit. Each (EA). One microtome, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Inspections and tests. Inspections and tests shall be conducted on the microtome, in accordance with commercial practice, to determine compliance with specification requirements. Sampling for inspections and tests shall be in accordance with commercial practice. In addition, an operational check shall be conducted on each microtome to demonstrate that the microtome and its controls are capable of proper operations.

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Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard 376, and all other requirements of this document are met. If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable. The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended, and as implemented by Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

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NOTE: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document.

6640-00-433-6000 MICROTOME, Rotary, Automatic

Ordering data. (Intermediate/exterior package quantities, labeling, and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order.)

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project Number: 6640-1632

Location: ENABLE/MICROC2/S31

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